

Change Management Leaders Toolkit

change management

communication

realpage

interaction essentials

who moved my cheese

transformation

successful

stakeholder

improve

business

accelerate

employees

development

why

key principles

leadership

emotions

transform

activities

metric

cheese

planning

purpose

trust

skills

disruption

monitor

control

run

focus

embrace

implement

people

customer

understand

seek

reinforce

process

sustain



Change Management: Leader's Toolkit

CONTENTS:

1. Toolkit & Content Overview

- i. Additional Resources

2. Change Management

- i. Run: Maintain current business capabilities
- ii. Improve: Improve existing business capabilities
- iii. Transform: Enable new business capabilities

3. Assessing & Understanding the Change

- i. Leader's Role
- ii. You and Your Team's Change IQ
- iii. Understanding the Change: Scoping the Change

4. Implementation & Impact: The Change Curve

- i. The Change Curve
- ii. Employee & Stakeholder Support System & Roles
- iii. Communication Plan

5. Reinforcing & Sustaining Change

- i. Success Metrics
- ii. Mile Markers

- All items in this page are hyperlinked for easy toolkit navigation and utilization. Click on the topic to get to the full content details and the tools directly.
- On each page, click on "back to content" to be routed back to the table of content page.

Toolkit Overview:

Leaders play a critical role in ensuring that change initiatives are successful, but change is difficult and involves a distinct process for each person engaged. A focused and organized strategy is necessary for the change path to be successful for you, your team, and our company.

The purpose of this toolkit is to guide leaders through the concepts of change management. It includes tools and best practices on how to lead yourself and others through the change management process.

Who should use this toolkit?

This toolkit is designed for RealPage leaders and HR Business Partners (HRBP).

How to use this toolkit?

The change management process is not linear. It is recommended that you reference the contents of this toolkit and use this toolkit throughout your change situation or on an as-needed basis as a guide and tool to support yourself and your team during change. Partner with your HRBP for specific guidance for your team.

This toolkit focuses on how leaders can effectively manage Change Management situations and to help employees embrace and adopt change in their day-to-day work.

Content Overview:

This toolkit is divided into three (3) main parts to help you in any stage of your change situations.

Part 1: Assessing & Understanding the Change – Helps you learn about the role of a leader in navigating and accelerating successful change implementations. You will also be assessing your teams' Change IQ to help you better prepare your Change Management approach. You will explore the scope of your change situations by exploring the What, Why, When, Who and How of your Change situations.

Part 2: Implementation & Impact: The Change Curve – Helps you understand and be mindful of the Emotional Cycle of Change. You will also use different tools to understand and consider the impact of Change to People, Process and Technology. You will also think about your Employee & Stakeholder Support system and their roles and plan on how to communicate the change effectively.

Part 3: Reinforcing & Sustaining Change – Helps you think about success metrics that ensures you are monitoring the progress and the success of the change. As a leader, it's critical to be proactive and intentional when providing support to your employees when navigating change. You'll be introduced to three-step Mile Markers that will provide best practices and tools to use with your teams during each phases of your change.

Mile Marker:

- 1 – Growth Beyond Disruption
- 2 – Sustaining Trust
- 3 – Create a New Normal

Additional resources

Here are some additional resources accessible for you and your team to explore and utilize on various platforms that will be beneficial as you implement change.

Who Moved my Cheese?

Is a great parable where characters represent different behaviors and attitudes toward change. Employees and leaders will learn different lessons on how to succeed in changing times.

Video: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hIBD4vJsPzo>

RPU Courses:

College of Personal and Professional Development

- **Overcoming Resistance to Change** - The course will help you learn about why people resist change and will provide tips on how to adapt to change. Utilizing interaction essentials and key principles to overcome people's resistance to change.

College of Management

- **Embracing Change** - This course will help you understand the three phases of change and will provide tips on supporting teammates as they navigate on each of the change phases.
- **Employee Webinar: Change Management** - In this webinar discussion, you'll learn about essential topics and tips to help navigate through change and embrace change quickly. You'll discover the Categories of Change (run, improve, transform) and the Emotional Cycle of Change. Additional tips referencing the book, Who Moved My Cheese? will also be provided to help you anticipate, manage, and celebrate change.

College of Engineering

- **Managing through Change** - In this course, you'll gain knowledge of the three-part transition process of change and how people respond and react to change. Additionally, the training will assist you in defining ways to strengthen team resilience and ensure that change is adopted by your team.

How do you access these topics? Go to RealPage University then from the Course Library go to the appropriate College category and scroll through to find the course. You can also type the course name in the search field to find the course in RPU.

Change Management

Change management is the systematic approach to managing employee engagement and adoption when an organization changes how work will be done. Its goal is to help individuals and teams adapt to changes in the organization in a smooth and efficient manner, while minimizing any obstructive impacts that may arise. The vision and details about the change need to be clear, consistent, and shared throughout the organization.

It is important to remember that the change process is not linear. Most change management theories visually illustrate the stages of change on a linear curve. In reality, navigating change looks more like a roller coaster with many twists and turns. Many times, there is movement forward, followed by steps backwards. Processing change depends on the person, the events unfolding, and several other factors. The goal is to progress through the change process towards (eventually) acceptance.

Most online data and publications about change acknowledges that **change is difficult**, and not all change efforts are successful. Without a specific and structured approach, many change efforts fall short of the goal, resulting in wasted time, effort, and resources. Taking a focused approach to managing change can make the difference between success and failure to meet project goals.

It's important to recognize that change does not and will not stop at RealPage. RealPage is going through significant "Transformation" but not all change is a Transformation.

In RealPage there are three categories of change: Run, Improve, Transform

- **Run:** Keeping the lights on! These types of change helps maintain current business capabilities. These changes help ensure that customers' expectations are met and maintained. *Change Timeline* – continuously moving forward and is always "today".
- **Improve:** Improve existing business capabilities or employee experience. These changes aim for us to get better in what we're doing and adds value to RealPage (revenue growth, renewal, slowing attrition, improve capabilities, etc.). These changes are continuous and often focused on improving cost efficiency, productivity, etc. *Change Timeline* – today from the next 3 to 4 years.
- **Transform:** Enable new business capabilities. Change that "changes the game" and creates new opportunities. Requires rigorous management to be successful.

It's important to frame and plan your discussions and change approach based on the needs and priorities of your department.

Assessing & Understanding the Change

Assessing and understanding change refers to the process of evaluating a change that an organization plans to implement and gaining an understanding of the potential impact of that change on the organization, its stakeholders, and its environment.

I. Leader's Role

Leaders play a critical role in change management, as they are responsible for creating and communicating a vision for change, guiding the organization through the change process, and ensuring that the change is successfully implemented.

Leaders Accelerate Change: To accelerate the implementation of the change, you'll need to help your team members embrace the change quickly, and in the process, create an agile work environment where team members are more open to change.

There are three main actions, or **Change Accelerators** that can assist your team in embracing change quickly:

- **Describe what's changing and why:** People tend to respond more favorably to change when they understand the business reasons for it and can see its benefits.
- **Seek reactions and feelings:** Seeking people's reactions helps them feel heard and involved in what's happening, which can go a long way toward building trust and commitment.
- **Regain a sense of control:** If people learn that they can control aspects of the change or at least have some influence over them, they'll be more open to change and more likely to take steps toward embracing it.

Change Accelerators in Action:

Describe what is changing and why.

- Ask open-ended questions to determine if people understand the whys and hows of a change.
- Provide relevant, compelling information to enable people to move forward; assist people in finding answers to critical questions and identify exactly what they are expected to do to carry out the change (to gain their commitment and support.)
- Encourage people to share insights and lessons learned to help others to embrace the change more quickly.
- Recognize previous successful initiatives.

Seek reactions and feelings.

- Draw out concerns, questions, and ideas by asking open-ended questions: “How are you feeling about this change?” and “What ideas do you have to make it work?”
- Acknowledge feelings of anxiety or discomfort: “I know you were comfortable with the current process and you’re anxious about learning a new system.”
- Provide a forum for sharing ideas and suggestions: “It would be helpful to hear your perspective. Would you be willing to share your thoughts at our next team meeting?”
- Create a list of pros and cons about the change and discuss them openly. Disclose your concerns.
- Create team operating principles for asking and receiving feedback or reactions. For example, have a “pause” option if someone needs more time or isn’t ready to share reactions or feelings on the spot.

Regain a sense of control.

- Work together to identify aspects of the change that people can control or influence. Ask if they would be willing to lead the charge in implementing those aspects of the change.
- Acknowledge when people might be feeling a lack of control: “I know you might feel that everything is out of control, so I’d like to take a few minutes to talk about what aspects of this change you might influence.”
- Encourage commitment, not just compliance: “You’ve accepted the change. Now let’s talk about what you can do to start to move forward with implementing it.”
- Encourage people to think of the positives: “You know this process best – what are your ideas for making it more efficient?”
- Help people identify manageable goals they are responsible for implementing. Suggest incremental steps.

II. You and Your Teams' Change IQ

What's Your and Your Teams' Change IQ?

A self-assessment to discover how you and your team react to change. This indicator will help you discover your standard approach to a particular change in your workplace. Be candid as you rate the statements.

Part One: Rating: Think of a specific workplace change you and your team are currently facing or will face soon. Using the scale below, rate each statement based on the degree to which it describes you and your actions or behaviors in the workplace. The assessment allows for rating for yourself and your team.

1 - Never, 2 - Seldom, 3 - Sometimes, 4 - Often, 5 - Always

		Self	Team
1.	I/They try to avoid or eliminate the need for change.	-	-
2.	I/They view the change as positive, yet unmanageable.	-	-
3.	I/They see the change as uncontrollable.	-	-
4.	I/They look for ways to incorporate the change in my daily work.	-	-
5.	I/They actively initiated the change.	-	-
6.	I/They voice my disagreement with the change repeatedly.	-	-
7.	I/They passively accept the change.	-	-
8.	I/They believe that the change is necessary for the evolution and survival of the organization.	-	-
9.	I/They am going along with the change only because others are on board.	-	-
10.	I/They am keeping a low profile and just getting through it.	-	-
11.	I/They solve problems related to the change by challenging existing processes and procedures.	-	-
12.	I/They challenge the change by identifying why it is not necessary, possible, or acceptable.	-	-
13.	I/They didn't initiate the change, but I'm dealing with it.	-	-
14.	I/They focus on what is staying the same despite the change.	-	-
15.	I/They believe that challenging the change helps me guard against unnecessary changes.	-	-
16.	I/They can be described as a risk taker.	-	-
17.	I/They believe that the change is something that I have to accept.	-	-
18.	I/They take small, incremental steps when implementing the change.	-	-
19.	I/They view the change as a negative event.	-	-
20.	I'm//They uncomfortable with the change but am doing what I have to do to make it work.	-	-

Part Two: Scores

	Leader	Team		Leader	Team
Resisting: (1,6,12,15,19)	0	0	Accommodating: (2,9,13, 17,20)	0	0
Observing: (3,7,10,14,18)	0	0	Embracing: (4,5,8,11,16)	0	0

Interpreting Your and Your Teams Score:

Consider the score for each change position—Resisting, Observing, Accommodating, and Embracing. Which position had the highest score? Refer to the Change IQ Continuum below to see the tendencies toward embracing the particular change you considered.

Change IQ Continuum



Change IQ Descriptions

Resisting

- Viewing the change as negative.
- Loudly voicing negative opinions about the change or questioning it repeatedly.
- Working to show that the change is not necessary, possible, or acceptable.
- Facing the difficult change by fighting or resisting it.
- Thinking: "Defy the change!"

Observing

- Seeing the change as uncontrollable and undesirable.
- Passively accepting the change, but making little or no progress toward implementing it.
- Focusing on what stays the same, rather than acknowledging the change.
- Honoring tradition and established practices.
- Thinking: "Ignore the change!"

Accommodating

- Seeing the change as positive but unmanageable.
- Being uncomfortable with the change, but going along with it out of loyalty to others involved.
- Thinking the change is inevitable, and it's just a matter of accepting it.
- Not initiating the change, but not resisting it either.
- Facing the difficult change cheerfully, but often using old methods rather than trying something new.
- Thinking: "Just deal with the change!"

Embracing

- Viewing the change as positive and manageable.
- Actively initiating the change.
- Seeing the change as ongoing.
- Working hard to incorporate the change into daily work.
- Facing the difficult change by trying new ways to make it work.
- Being comfortable with risk and uncertainty.
- Thinking: "I am excited about the change!"

III. Understanding the Change

Change is the process of transforming or altering something improve it, adapt it to new circumstances, or achieve a specific goal. Change can take many different forms, such as organizational restructuring, process improvement, or the introduction of new products or services.

As announcements are made and decisions unfold, some changes are immediately known, while other information remains ambiguous until the full transaction unfolds. The process is a journey that requires a focused and structured approach to ensure success for you, your team, and our organization.

As a leader, it's important to have a full understanding of the change. This includes learning about the objective and scope of the change. This information will serve as a solid foundation for future decisions that will be made.

Change Scoping Form	
What is the Change?	
Define the need for change.	
What is the objective of the change?	
What will be the "outcome" of this change? Can you describe it?	
What effect will this change have on the organization?	
What behavioral changes will be needed to meet these objectives?	
What are we doing currently and why is the change needed?	
When is the change happening and when does it need to be completed?	
Who is impacted by the change? How will it affect them? Organization level? Department level? Individual level? Customer level?	
How is the change going to be implemented?	

Implementation & Impact

I. The Change Curve

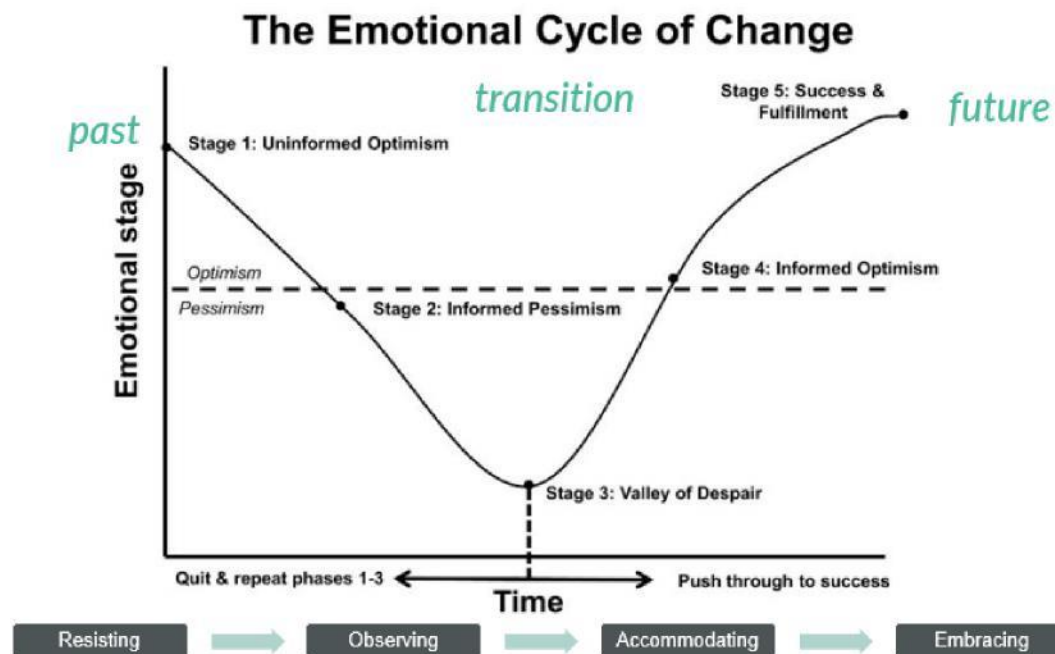
Every organization brings about changes in its processes, management, and operations. During these changes, there must be a change in the people as well. Only when people make the transitions can the organization move ahead and reap the full benefits of the change.

The quicker teammates move along on their journey through the cycle of change, the easier it will be for our organization to move towards success. The change curve can help you better understand and anticipate how one will react to change and how to provide support to your team members.

The emotional cycle of change model was created by Don Kelly and Daryl Conner. The cycle shows five stages – Uninformed Optimism, Informed Pessimism, Valley of Despair, Informed Optimism, and Fulfillment. This outlines how your emotional response (usually based on how much the change will affect you personally) is likely to alter as you go through a change.

In this emotional cycle of change, people can easily get into the valley of despair. It's important to acknowledge that this is part of the change process, and you need to help your team members move through this stage as quickly as possible. The change continuum below the change curve shows the behaviors of these stages of emotions: Resisting, Observing, Accommodating and Embracing.

The change curve is not linear, but the goal is to move towards the future, eventually to embrace the change as a new norm.



II. Impact & Assessments

Please use the tool below to assess the impact of your change situation.

To complete an Impact Assessment, brainstorm cross-functional stakeholders who can represent various aspects of the change. Engage with people who can provide critical information, context and data on which plans can be built.

Plan your conversation with the following objectives:

1. Learn what the changes will mean and how it will impact your employees, team members, process, and technology.
2. Uncover the benefits of the change.
3. Anticipate and prepare for employee resistance, emotional reactions and other potential barriers.

REMEMBER!

- Be proactive. As soon as a decision is close and there is enough information to warrant a conversation about what the change will mean to your employees, take action.
- Take responsibility for actions to amplify benefits and lessen denial impacts.

Impact Assessment Tool			
	People	Process	Technology
Impact Level (high, moderate, low)			
Benefits/Value <i>Think about following: efficiency, behaviors, skills, development customers, collaborations, metric</i>			
Anticipated Resistance and Barriers			

III. Employee & Stakeholder Support System & Roles

Employee

One crucial step to implementing a successful change management initiative is identifying employees that you can leverage and can assist you with the implementation of change.

Identify your Change Champion, Change Agents and Change Empath

Change Champions

Characteristics: These types of employees are typically highly motivated, enthusiastic about the change and are **often willing to go above and beyond**.

Role: Participate in the planning of change management. Helps in implementing and promoting the change. Provide ideas and solutions to address change process gaps.

Change Agents

Characteristics: These employees adapt to new initiatives and are able to quickly see the benefits of change and are willing to embrace change. They are willing to **take on new challenges, learn new skills, and help to create a culture that is innovative and growth oriented**.

Role: Observes and monitors the change, provides feedback about the effect, impact and benefits of the change throughout the change implementation, helps in creating a change culture behavior in the team.

Change Empaths

Characteristics: These employees have the ability to sense and observe people's feeling and reactions. They help create a positive environment. **They are easily trusted and relied on by their teammates**.

Role: Touchbase with the team to learn and understand the personal effect of change for team members. Support team members during the change implementation process. Provide feedback, ideas, and solutions that help teammates embrace change quicker.

Based on the above, write the names of your Change Champions, Agents, and Empath below:

Role	Names
Change Champion/s	
Change Agents	
Change Empath/s	

Stakeholders

A stakeholder is a person who has a vested interest in something and who is impacted by and cares about how it the change project turns out. This will include individuals aligned with your vision, goals and objectives who may have a vested interest in the outcome and may want to provide input to allies that share your vision and want it to succeed and will provide support, critical resources, information or expertise. Complete a Stakeholder Analysis to determine who may need to be involved in the change and to what extent.

Below are definitions to assist you in completing a Stakeholder Analysis:

- **Stakeholder Name** – Who are your stakeholders in this change situation? Identify each person you need to influence.
- **Role** – What is their role in the change? Examples may include: approval required, provide resources, escalate needs, downstream impact, inform, project team member, etc.
- **Impact** – How important is this stakeholder in the success of your change management plan? (**High, Medium, Low**)
- **Engagement Plan** – List action items to continuously connect with and update each stakeholder.

As you anticipate reactions — especially resistance— be open to the opportunity to learn. It is very likely the resistance will be from a place of knowledge and concern about potential barriers or important issues that will need to be addressed. Listen carefully and be willing to address issues raised.

Stakeholder Name	Role	Impact	Engagement Plan

IV. Communication Plan

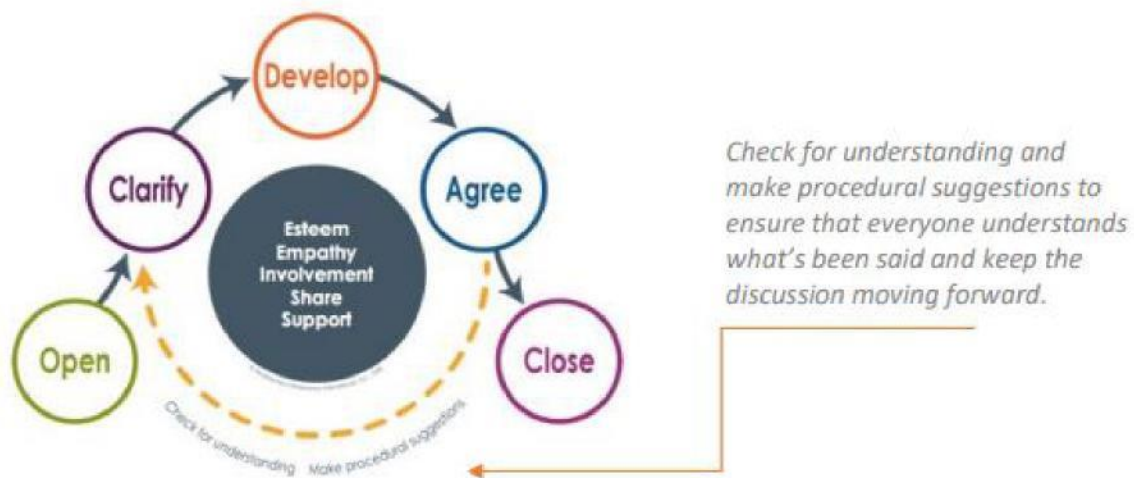
Having a strategic communication plan is an essential component to ensure organizational awareness and support to your change situations.

Refer to the Interaction Essentials framework below to communicate for success and spark action in others. When applied, the Interaction Essentials helps you meet both the personal (human needs) and practical (objectives) needs of your organization.

The Interaction Essentials are:

- Key Principles (to meet personal needs)
- Interaction Guidelines (to meet practical needs)

The Interaction EssentialsSM



Key Principles (to meet personal needs)	Interaction Guidelines (to meet practical needs)
Esteem – Express confidence in your team’s ability to carry out the change. Empathy – Acknowledge the emotions people are expressing about the change. Involvement – Help team members feel involved and more in control of the situation. Share – Share your personal thoughts and concerns. Support – Encourage people and provide support while holding them responsible for implementing the change.	Open by identifying what is changing and why. (Describe what’s changing and why.) Clarify how the change affects the person or team. (Seek reactions and feelings.) Develop ideas for implementing the change. (Regain a sense of control.) Agree on a plan for implementing the change. Close by summarizing and expressing confidence.

Communication Plan Considerations

Communication is critical when it comes to Change Management! The goal of change communication is to facilitate sustained realization of the change goal by recommitting people along the way. As you are communicating change, keep in mind that people have a limited capacity to absorb information under stress, so you need to be consistent and purposeful in your communication. Communicate often and frequently.

Consider the following when planning your communication:

- **Communication Objectives:** Think about what you want to achieve before making any communication actions. Your objectives should align with the change vision and business objective.
- **Desired Behavior:** As you draft the words in your communication think about the change in mindset and behaviors that you want to achieve in your message. What do you want your audience to feel about the message and the change? How do you want your audience to react?
- **Modes of Communication:** Communication is not a one-size fits all. Think about your audience and teams and plan the best avenue for communication. Do you need to set up meetings (small-large), send emails, create a group chat, have 1:1 discussions, etc.
- **Communication Content:** Each communication should be intentionally planned. Think about the relevant and useful information that you put in your communication content that will help you achieve your objectives like updates, resources, key milestones, acknowledgement, calls to action items, data or results and celebrations.
- **Communication Cadence:** The frequency of communication and timelines should be closely tied to your change management plans and should reflect intermittent milestones that celebrate success.
- **Communication Calendar:** This will layout the what and when the communication will need to happen from beginning to the end of Change Management Implementation.

Communication Plan Template:

Communication Objective:	
Desired Behavior:	
Modes of Communication:	
Cadence:	
Communication Calendar:	

Reinforcing & Sustaining Change

I. Success Metrics

When implementing change, it is imperative to have Success Metrics. Success Metrics are the metrics that help leadership assess the overall health and success of the change. Success Metrics are useful across all levels of the organization as they evaluate, indicate, and measure performance based on the objectives set forth by the change initiative.

Success Metrics: Criteria for Goals, Action Steps and Performance Measures

Goals	Specific —Are stated in terms that avoid confusion about what is to be achieved.	Measurable —Are defined in terms of quantity, cost, timeliness, and/or quality.	Attainable —Are achievable and reflect activities and events the team has significant control over.	Relevant —Support the team's purpose.	Time bound —Are stated in terms of when or how often.
Action Steps	Specific —Answer these questions: What will be done? By whom? By when?	Observable —Are easy to monitor and clearly show when something has been done.	Supportive of the goal —Have an obvious link to achievement of the goal.	Realistic —Involve things the team has the opportunity and the capability to do	Within budget —Can be accomplished with the resources and funds available to the team.
Performance Measures	Frequent —Provide timely and regular feedback to the team.	Accurate —Provide fact - based feedback on the team's progress.	Relevant —Reflect the team's impact on its goals and on the activities, that are under the team's control.	Simple —Use tracking systems that are available, accessible, and easy to complete.	Visible —Can be displayed graphically.

Questions to think about when identifying team goals:

- How do our purpose and accountabilities translate into our team and organization goals?
- What are the top three things we hope to accomplish?

Questions to think about when developing action steps:

- What do we need to do, change, share, improve, create, eliminate, or establish to achieve our goal?
- Who needs to be involved? Who is the best person to complete this step?

Questions to think about when identifying performance measures:

- How will we track our progress? How frequently?
- What tracking methods do we have in place to measure our progress?

Questions to think about when identifying resources:

- What resources do we have? What additional resources do we need? How will we get them?

Goals, Action Steps, and Performance Measures Template - What do we need to achieve, and how will we achieve it? How will we measure our success?			
Goal 1:	Measures:		
Action Steps	Who?	By When?	Resources
Updates:			

Goals, Action Steps, and Performance Measures Template- What do we need to achieve, and how will we achieve it? How will we measure our success?			
Goal 2:	Measures:		
Action Steps:	Who?	By When?	Resources
Updates:			

II. Mile Markers

One of the most impactful ways to lead your team through change is to model the behavior that you want to see in them. With many teammates working in a hybrid environment, it's critical to be proactive and intentional with the support you provide. To navigate the change, the following three-step Road Map provides best practices and tools to use with your teams during each phase.

Mile Marker:

1. Growth Beyond Disruption
2. Sustaining Trust
3. Create a New Normal

These Mile Markers indicate the direction we are heading. You may determine to use the tools in sequential order, while other leaders will use them differently. These tools are available for you to leverage, as needed, depending on what is happening, specific to you and your team. The overall goal is to lead your team through the transition of past to future.

Mile Marker 1 – Growth Beyond Disruption

When to use: Most useful when a new change is announced and there is disruption happening. Many people will have the tendency to resist or observe the change at this point. Often these reactions occur because of the uncertainty of what the future holds.

BEST PRACTICES

- Sleep on it. Refrain from sharing your thoughts, feelings, and reactions just yet.
- Evaluate by yourself or with others what aspects of the change you can control or influence and what aspects you can't control.
- Seek to understand the vision and the change strategy. Post this information in your work areas or on your team intranet site.
- Don't jump to conclusions or make assumptions. Instead, make a list of clarifying questions.
- Determine how the change differs from your expectations: "I expected ____; now, ____ might happen."
- Ask yourself, "How does this change affect my plans for the future?" Make a list of what you will gain or lose.
- Consider the business impact of the change. Ask yourself, "What good could come of this change in terms of budget, resources, time, profitability, productivity, morale, customers, and competition?"
- Know that you can and will get through this change. Say a daily affirmation.
- Ask yourself, "What is it about this change that is making me feel fearful, anxious, excited, etc.?"
- Apply lessons learned from similar change experiences.
- Periodically revisit your Change IQ. Consciously reframe your thoughts to enhance your placement.
- Identify what you need before you can move to the next phase of change. Think about what is feasible and what resources you need to make it happen.

Discussion Planner

The Discussion Planner provides prompts to help you:

- Decide which Key Principles you'll focus on and determine your approach to the discussion.
- Prepare what you'll say at each stage of the discussion using the Interaction Guidelines, including how much time you expect to spend on each step.
- Provide feedback to yourself after the discussion
- You can use this discussion planner during your team meetings or one-on-one sessions.

Discussion with: _____ **Date:** _____

What do you want to discuss? Why is it important?

What is your objective for the discussion?

How will you know whether the person/team has accomplished the task or is achieving the desired result of the discussion?

What are the personal needs, tendencies, or characteristics of this person/team that you need to consider?

Opportunities:

Challenges:

Post-Discussion Notes:

- What did I say or do to use the skills effectively?
- What could I say or do to use the skills more effectively next time?

Mile Marker 2 – Sustaining Trust

At this point, more information is known, and people are beginning to understand the circumstances better. This is a critical time to maintain and sustain trust with your team.

BEST PRACTICES

- Seek information from your business world—team members, leadership, competition, customers, technologies, regulations.
- Develop a network of people with whom you can discuss lessons learned, fears, challenges, expectations, strategies, and progress.
- Be a catalyst by supporting and encouraging others to enhance their Change IQs. Use Key Principles.
- Create a community bulletin board or intranet site to discuss issues, generate ideas, and track progress toward the change.
- Identify barriers and solicit support from appropriate resources.
- List the positives and negatives of the change during a team meeting. Revisit the list periodically; record insights about the benefits and brainstorm strategies to overcome the challenges.
- Make discussion of rumors and assumptions a standing agenda item for team meetings.
- Clarify roles, responsibilities, and degree of ownership with leaders.
- Ask yourself and others, “Are we getting in the way of our own success by being satisfied with the status quo or not being open to change?”
- Commit to being part of the implementation, then identify and set ambitious goals.
- Determine quick steps to build momentum toward the change goal. When identifying these steps, ask yourself and others, “Will this activity increase productivity?”
- Work with others to make the change work. Eliminate wasteful or obsolete activities.
- Don’t be satisfied with initial ideas—push yourself and others to generate other options before committing to a course of action.
- Think creatively to identify helpful resources.
- Generate a list of questions, such as, “What are our roles and responsibilities? What level of decision-making will we have?” and then ask them of the appropriate people. Understand that answers to all your questions might not be available right away.
- Identify short-term goals, track progress, and then celebrate short-term wins.
- Ask yourself, “What can I do to make this change work?” List all the possibilities.
- Identify information-gathering activities, such as Internet searches, webinars, or interviews, that you can do to move closer to the change goal.
- Take action with urgency and purpose. Make strides toward the change goal every day. Identify specific dates for getting things done.
- Identify opportunities to work with people who are positive, supportive, or enthusiastic about this change. Watch, listen, and apply lessons learned.
- Find out what people are doing to succeed in other organizations undergoing change. Consider how their methods could be applied to your organization.

Change Management: Leader Self-Assessment

Feedback Survey

One of the most effective ways to monitor your progress and continuously improve your skills and approach in Change Management is to reflect and assess yourself on how you did well on your Change Management implementation.

Leveraging Results

You can leverage the survey results in several ways to improve your leadership skills:

- **Meet with your manager:** Schedule time with your manager to discuss your results and
 - Identify additional opportunities to apply your strengths and to work on areas you would like to develop.
 - Determine which skills or techniques you can use more frequently.
 - Identify the positive impact your improved skills are having on you as a leader, your team, and the organization.
- **Measure and monitor skill application:** To monitor your progress and measure the impact, you will receive a survey, twice a year that will you reflect on your strengths and opportunities on Change Management.

The assessment will target to understand the skills and competencies of our leaders in the organization on Change Management: It will focus on the following categories:

- Assessing and Understanding Change
- Implementation of Change
- Managing the Employee Impact of Change
- Reinforcing & Sustaining Change Effectiveness

Mile Marker 3 – Create a New Normal

When to use: These tips are best leveraged when changes are already implemented and the focus is now on the future, the new normal. Specific areas of focus are keeping organizational talent and maximizing team performance.

BEST PRACTICES

- Be on the lookout for continuous improvement ideas.
- Make suggestions in the spirit of continuous learning and ongoing improvement.
- Perhaps identify new challenges that could be addressed in similar ways to recently embraced changes.
- List the lessons learned from this change. Revisit compelling success stories during team meetings or on a team intranet site. Refer to these lists to consider improvement ideas that could result in longer-term benefits to the organization and its customers.
- Identify barriers to innovation, such as the ones imposed by you, the department, the organization, or the process. Use this knowledge wisely as you make improvements or future changes.
- Commit to making the new change stick—for example, link the integrated change to yearly performance plans.
- Recall what you specifically did or said to move yourself and others toward Embracing on the Change IQ. Apply what worked to upcoming changes.
- Celebrate success at both team and personal levels.

Keeping Organizational Talent: Best Practices

Leaders	Best Practices
Recognition —Appropriate acknowledgment that fits the achievement.	▪ Base recognition on objective measures of performance. ▪ Make sure all deserving people are recognized. ▪ Recognize actions and results. ▪ Personalize recognition to suit individual preferences (for example, how you offer it and what it is). ▪ Publicly recognize others' accomplishments. Solicit the help of peers and colleagues in the reward and selection process. ▪ Nominate people for organizational awards. ▪ Celebrate performance that exceeds expectations, completion of a challenging task, outstanding customer service, and career milestones. ▪ Ensure that financial rewards, such as bonuses and profit sharing, are tied to individual or team performance. ▪ Provide recognition face-to-face when possible. ▪ Practice the guidelines for effective recognition—timely, specific, sincere, proportional, and personal.

Support—Providing the resources, information, and tools needed for team success and effecting change of processes and rules that inhibit team success.	▪ Provide support without removing responsibility: ○ Ask how you can help people do their jobs. ○ Obtain the resources people need. ○ Listen to others' concerns and help them find answers. ○ Show confidence and trust. ○ Don't take over. ○ Help remove barriers to success. ▪ Influence others to help remove barriers. ▪ Help people find ways to gain support from others. ▪ Lead change on outdated processes.
Opportunity to learn—Access to training, learning events, or new assignments that are relevant to success in a person's current job or in future career opportunities.	▪ Involve people in determining development goals and activities. ▪ Provide or help others find assignments that target their development needs. ▪ Budget for and arrange training and learning opportunities to support development needs. ▪ Before training, meet with the person to determine objectives and how he or she will apply new skills. ▪ Follow up after the training to determine how the person has applied skills to the job. ▪ Create a cross-training or rotation program to broaden people's experience and create a team atmosphere. ▪ Develop and document training paths for each person, building toward greater responsibilities.
Feedback—Meaningful observations that include a description of the situation, action, and result.	▪ Meet regularly with people to discuss their progress, issues, obstacles, and development plans. ▪ Maintain a development file for each person, with notes on review sessions and positive and developmental behaviors; use the notes during feedback discussions. ▪ Collect articles and development tips to share with your group. ▪ Ensure that you provide feedback equitably and with an appropriate ratio of positive and developmental comments.
Celebrating success- Continuously recognize and acknowledge the progress made.	▪ Recognize and appreciate the hard work and dedication of everyone involved in making the change a success. ▪ Share success stories to help reinforce the value of the change and demonstrate its impact. ▪ Celebrate the milestones achieved during the change process. Set up specific goals and milestones and celebrate when they are achieved. ▪ Organize a celebration event such as a team lunch, a recognition ceremony, or a fun team-building activity to celebrate the success of the change.

Thank you for using this resource. For questions or suggestions, email:

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